

The chair of Management of Digital Food Businesses, in cooperation with EVANIUM is offering a

Project study

on the topic of

Data-Driven Customer Selection and Market Prioritization for a B2B Nutraceutical Ingredient Startup

EVANIUM is a life science startup based in Regensburg, Germany, dedicated to unlocking the full potential of plant-based active compounds.

Our proprietary OPTISOLV® Technology, a patented dual-coating system (cyclodextrin core + phospholipid shell), significantly improves water solubility, bioavailability, and taste profile of botanical extracts. We are a B2B company focusing on the development of next generation ingredients, with a portfolio of now four compounds including OPTISOLV® Curcumin, Berberine, Boswellia, and Passiflora. We are supplying distributors, contract manufacturers and brands in four different industries: nutraceuticals, functional foods, cosmetics, and pharmaceuticals. At the end of 2025 we closed a €2.2M seed round, led by FoodLabs, one of the key venture capital companies in the field of food in Germany. Over the last six years we have developed our now IP-protected technology and are now starting to scale the company. This year we started to exhibit at international trade fairs, the first one was VitaFoods Europe, which we won the award for “Most Innovative Nutraceutical Ingredient” for our OPTISOLV® Berberine.

Scope of the project

EVANIUM’s B2B go-to-market strategy requires precise identification and prioritization of the right customers across supplement formulators, private-label brands, and contract manufacturers.

Without a scalable, criteria-based approach, commercial development relies too heavily on ad-hoc outreach and personal networks. This project study addresses the following core questions:

- Which quantitative and qualitative criteria determine the ideal customer profile (ICP) for EVANIUM, and how can these be systematically applied to evaluate and score potential B2B partners?
- How can publicly available and commercial data sources (company databases, regulatory filings, LinkedIn, market reports) be used to build and continuously enrich a qualified customer pipeline?
- Which markets (countries, channels, segment clusters) should EVANIUM prioritize for expansion over the next three years, based on market size, ingredient demand, and regulatory environment?

- What scalable commercial intelligence system, including data sources, tools, scoring model, and review cadence, can EVANIUM implement?

Requirements

- Strong interest to experience fast paced startup dynamics and work closely with the founders
- Strong analytical and structured thinking skills; ability to design and apply scoring frameworks
- Interest in B2B commercial strategy, market entry, or business development
- Ideally experience with market research methods; familiarity with CRM logic, lead qualification, or sales processes is a plus
- Comfort working with databases, spreadsheets, and/or CRM-like tools
- Open to join us at our laboratories in Regensburg, Germany (1 hour distance to Munich)

Start and duration: Winter Semester 2026/27 (October 2026) · 3 months full-time / 6 months part-time

Language: English (German welcome)

Number of participants: 3–5 students

Supervisor TUM: Chair of Management of Digital Food Businesses

Supervisors EVANIUM: Eliza Weitzel, founders associate and marketing responsible

Application

If you are interested, please send an email to Eliza (e.weitzel@evanium.de) to express your interest. Please include a short motivation letter (max. 1 page), your current CV, and your most recent transcript of records.